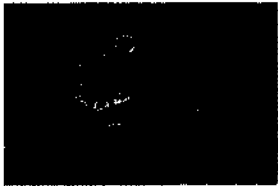
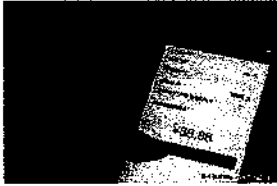


## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

This letter to the editor appeared in a local newspaper:

| E-lai see                                                                                            |                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>Old lai see</p>  | <p>New lai see</p>  |

E-payment is becoming ever more popular in Hong Kong, and is even used in the traditional wet markets, as most customers find it convenient. After 20 years Octopus no longer has a monopoly, with rivals such as Alipay and Apple Pay competing for a share of the pie.

Although technology definitely enhances our quality of life, in some areas traditional money is still important. For example, can an electronic red packet really convey the same warmth and feeling as a real *lai see* (or red packets) full of new bank notes? Is giving new notes still a must for *lai see*?

Whatever you yourself feel about these questions, the change is already well underway in China. The United Overseas Bank found four out of five people in mainland China gave digital *lai see* this year. The traditional values of the Lunar New Year would seem to be being replaced by new habits in the digital era.

To me, and to many people of my generation, the Lunar New Year should be about fireworks, good food, visits to parents and relatives, New Year greetings and real money *lai see* gifts. Family reunions should be given top priority as people celebrate, but young people are starting to see it differently and the use of electronic *lai see* is just another example of their indifferent attitude towards the spring festival and traditional values in general.

Ivy Fung, Yau Yat Chuen

You have been asked to write an essay titled: "Are Hongkongers open to change?" Your group has been asked to discuss the use of e-payments as *lai see*. You may want to talk about:

- why people are using e-payments for *lai see*
- whether real money will remain popular
- what other changes to the Lunar New Year people might dislike
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Is electronic *lai see* popular in Hong Kong?
2. Have you received any electronic *lai see*?
3. Would you prefer to receive electronic *lai see* or a real *lai see*?
4. Why are e-payments not popular in Hong Kong?
5. Is giving *lai see* old-fashioned?
6. Why do you think e-payment is used so widely in China?
7. What does giving *lai see* show about a person?
8. Is technology making personal relationships less close?